

# Machine learning with mlr3::CHEAT SHEET

## Class Overview

The mlr3 package builds on R6 classes and provides the essential building blocks of a machine learning workflow.

## mlr3 Dictionaries

Key-value store for sets of mlr objects. These are provided by mlr3:

- mlr\_tasks - ML example tasks.
- mlr\_task\_generators - Example generators.
- mlr\_learners - ML algorithms.
- mlr\_measures - Performance measures.
- mlr\_resamplings - Resampling strategies.

These dictionaries can be extended by loading extension packages. For example, by loading the **mlr3learners** package, the mlr\_learners dictionary is extended with more learners. Syntactic sugar functions retrieve objects from dictionaries, set hyperparameters and assign fields in one go e.g. lrn("classif.rpart", cp = 0.1).

```
Dictionary$keys(pattern = NULL)
```

Returns all keys which match pattern. If NULL, all keys are returned.

```
Dictionary$get(key, ...)
```

Retrieves object by key and passes arguments "..." to the construction of the objects.

```
Dictionary$smget(keys, ...)
```

Retrieves objects by keys and passes named arguments "..." to the construction of the objects.

```
as.data.table(Dictionary)
```

Lists objects with metadata.

## Class: Task

Stores data and metadata. x can be a data.table, target points to y-column by name.

```
task = as_task_regr(backend, target)
```

Create task for regression or classification.

```
task = tsk(.key)
```

Sugar to get example task from mlr\_tasks:

- Twoclass: german\_credit, pima, sonar, spam
- Multiclass: iris, wine, zoo
- Regression: boston\_housing, mtcars

Print the mlr\_tasks dictionary for more.

```
task$positive = "<positive_class>"
```

Set positive class for binary classification.

## Column Roles

Column roles affect the behavior of the task for different operations. Set with task\$col\_roles\$<role> = "<column\_name>":

- feature - Regular features.
- target - Target variable.
- name - Labels for plots.
- group - Groups for block resampling.
- stratum - Stratification variables.
- weights\_learner - Observation weights for training.
- weights\_measure - Observation weights for scoring.

## Data Operations

```
task$select(cols)
```

Subsets the task based on feature names.

```
task$filter(rows)
```

Subsets the task based on row ids.

```
task$cbind(data) / task$rbind(data)
```

Adds additional columns / rows.

```
task$rename(from, to)
```

Rename columns.

## Class: Learner

Wraps learners from R with a unified interface.

```
learner = lrn(.key, ...)
```

Get learner by .key (from mlr\_learners) and construct the learner with specific hyperparameters and settings "..." in one go. [github.com/mlr-org/mlr3learners](https://github.com/mlr-org/mlr3learners) (R package) and [github.com/mlr3learners](https://github.com/mlr3learners) (GitHub organization) hold all available learners.

```
learner$param_set
```

Returns description of hyperparameters.

```
learner$param_set$values = list(id = value)
```

Change the current hyperparameter values by assigning a named list(id = value) to the \$values field. This overwrites all previously set parameters.

```
learner$param_set$values$<id> = <value>
```

Update a single hyperparameter.

```
learner$predict_type = "<type>"
```

Changes/sets the output type of the prediction. For classification, "response" means class labels, "prob" means posterior probabilities. For regression, "response" means numeric response, "se" extracts the standard error.

## Example

```
task = tsk("sonar")
learner = lrn("classif.rpart")

train_set = sample(task$nrow, 0.8 * task$nrow)
test_set = setdiff(seq_len(task$nrow), train_set)

learner$train(task, row_ids = train_set)

prediction = learner$predict(task, row_ids = test_set)
prediction$score()
## > classif.ce
## > 0.2619048
```

## Train & Predict

```
learner$train(task, row_ids)
```

Train on (selected) observations.

```
learner$model
```

The resulting model is stored in the \$model slot of the learner.

```
prediction = learner$predict(task, row_ids)
```

Predict on (selected) observations.

## Measures & Scoring

```
measure = msr(.key)
```

Get measure by .key from `mlr\_measures`:

- classif.ce - Classification error.
- classif.auc - AUROC.
- regr.rmse - Root mean square error.

Print mlr\_measures for all measures.

```
prediction$score(measures)
```

Calculate performance with one or more measures.

## Class: Resampling

Define partitioning of task into train and test sets. Creation: `resampling = rspm(.key, ...)`

- `holdout (ratio)` Holdout-validation.
- `cv (folds)` k-fold cross-validation.
- `repeated_cv (folds, repeats)` Repeated k-fold cross-validation.
- `subsampling (repeats, ratio)` Repeated holdouts.
- `bootstrap (repeats, ratio)` Out-of-bag bootstrap.
- Custom splits

```
resampling = rspm("custom")
resampling$instantiate(task,
  train = list(c(1:10, 51:60, 101:110)),
  test = list(c(11:20, 61:70, 111:120)))
```

```
resampling$param_set
```

Returns a description of parameter settings.

```
resampling$param_set$values = list(folds = 10)
```

Sets folds to 10.

```
task$col_roles$stratum = "<column_names>"
```

Sets stratification variables.

```
task$col_roles$group = "<column_name>"
```

Sets group variable.

```
resampling$instantiate(task)
```

Perform splitting and define index sets.

## Resample

Train-Predict-Score a learner on each train/test set.

```
rr = resample(task, learner, resampling)
```

Returns a `ResampleResult` container object.

```
rr$score(measures)
```

Returns a `data.table` of scores on test sets.

```
rr$aggregate(measures)
```

Gets aggregated performance scores as vector.

```
rr$filter(iters)
```

Filters to specific iterations.

## Example

```
library(mlr3learners)
task = tsk("pima")
learner = lrn("classif.rpart", predict_type = "prob")
measure = msr("classif.ce")
resampling = rspm("cv", folds = 3L)
resampling$instantiate(task)
rr = resample(task, learner, resampling)
as.data.table(rr)[, list(resampling, iteration, prediction)]
## >      resampling iteration prediction
## > 1: <ResamplingCV[19]>      1 <PredictionClassif[19]>
## > 2: <ResamplingCV[19]>      2 <PredictionClassif[19]>
## > 3: <ResamplingCV[19]>      3 <PredictionClassif[19]>
rr$aggregate(measure)
## > classif.ce
## > 0.2239583
learners = lrns(c("classif.rpart", "classif.ranger"))
tasks = tsks(c("sonar", "spam"))
resampling = rspm("cv", folds = 3L)
design = benchmark_grid(tasks, learners, resampling)
bmr = benchmark(design)
bmr
## >
## >      learner      resampling iteration
## > 1: <LearnerClassifRpart[33]> <ResamplingCV[19]>      1
## > 2: <LearnerClassifRpart[33]> <ResamplingCV[19]>      2
## > 3: <LearnerClassifRpart[33]> <ResamplingCV[19]>      3
## > 4: <LearnerClassifRanger[33]> <ResamplingCV[19]>      1
bmr$aggregate()[, list(nr, resample_result, task_id, learner_id, classif.ce)]
## >      nr resample_result task_id learner_id classif.ce
## > 1: 1 <ResampleResult[21]> sonar classif.rpart 0.30276052
## > 2: 2 <ResampleResult[21]> sonar classif.ranger 0.17308489
## > 3: 3 <ResampleResult[21]> spam classif.rpart 0.09997865
## > 4: 4 <ResampleResult[21]> spam classif.ranger 0.04868526
```

Results are stored as a `data.table`. `BenchmarkResult` contains a `ResampleResult` object for each task-learner-resampling combination which in turn contain a `Prediction` object for each resampling iteration.

## Benchmark

Compare learner(s) on task(s) with resampling(s).

```
design = benchmark_grid(
  tasks, learners, resamplings)
```

Creates a cross-join datatable with list-columns. Can also be set up manually for full control.

```
bmr = benchmark(design)
```

Returns a `BenchmarkResult` container.

```
bmr$aggregate(measures)
```

`data.table` of `ResampleResult` with scores.

```
bmr$score(measures)
```

Data `data.table` of resampling iterations with scores.

```
bmr$filter(task_ids = task_ids,
  learner_ids = learner_ids,
  resampling_ids = resampling_ids)
```

Filter by task, learner and resampling.

```
bmr$combine(bmr1)
c(bmr, bmr1) # alternative S3 method
```

Merge other `BenchmarkResult`.

## Parallelization

The future framework is used for parallelization.

```
future::plan(backend)
```

Selects the parallelization backend for the current session. Parallelization is automatically applied to all levels (resampling, tuning and FeatSel).

## Logging

`lgr` is used for logging and progress output.

```
getOption("lgr.log_levels")
## > fatal error warn info debug trace
## > 100 200 300 400 500 600
```

Gets threshold levels. The default is 400.

```
lgr::get_logger("mlr3")$set_threshold("<level>")
```

Changes the log-level on a per-package basis.

## mlr3viz

Provides visualization for `mlr3` objects. Creation: `mlr3viz::autoplot(object, type)`

- `BenchmarkResult` (boxplot of performance measures, roc, prc)
- `Filter` (barplot of filter scores)
- `PredictionClassif` (Stacked barplot of true and estimated class labels, roc, prc)
- `PredictionRegr` (xy scatterplot, histogram of residuals)
- `ResampleResult` (boxplot or histogram of performance measures, roc, prc)
- `TaskClassif` (barplot of target, duo target-features plot matrix, pairs feature plot matrix with color set to target)
- `TaskRegr` (target, pairs)
- `TaskSurv` (target, duo, pairs)

## Error Handling and Encapsulation

Packages evaluate and `callr` can be used to encapsulate execution of `$train()` and `$predict()` to prevent stops in case of errors - useful for larger experiments. `callr` isolates the execution in a separate R sessions, guarding against segfaults.

```
learner$encapsulate("evaluate",
  fallback = lrn("classif.featureless"))
```

```
learner$errors
```

Returns the log of recorded errors.

```
learner$encapsulate("evaluate", fallback = lrn(.key))
```

If learner fails, a fallback learner is used to generate predictions. Use a robust fallback, e.g. a “featureless” learner.

## Resources

- [mlr3book](https://mlr3book.com) (https://mlr3book.com)
- [mlr-org on GitHub](https://github.com/mlr-org) (https://github.com/mlr-org)
- [mlr3learners R package](https://github.com/mlr-org/mlr3learners) (https://github.com/mlr-org/mlr3learners)
- [mlr3learners organization](https://github.com/mlr3learners) (https://github.com/mlr3learners)
- [mlr3gallery use cases](https://mlr3gallery.com/) (https://mlr3gallery.com/)